Ghulam Mohammed was called in and he only agreed to participate in the coup if Abdullah was arrested in the process, thereby rendering him politically ineffective. Dr Karan Singh was now about to face the first major political battle of his career; it was ironic that it was his father who had released Abdullah from imprisonment in September 1947 and acquiesced thereafter, clearing the way for him to take over power in the State. Exactly six years later, Karan Singh was now deposing Abdullah from the same seat of power and sending him back to jail. Life had run a full circle and the Maharaja had been partially avenged by the crown prince.[31]

Maj. B. S. Bajwa, ADC to the Sadr-e-Riyasat, accompanied by a police party, was sent to Gulmarg to arrest Abdullah in the early hours of the morning of 9 August 1953.[32] Abdullah and his wife were driven out to Udhampur and were detained at the Tara Niwas guest house. Karan Singh, thereafter, swore in Bakshi Ghulam Mohammed to replace Abdullah. The Indian Army and allied security forces in the state were placed on alert and various other security measures, including press censorship, were announced. Under the new administration of Bakshi Ghulam Mohammed and with the fall of Abdullah, the Praja Parishad agitation in Jammu died away. The death of Shyama Prasad Mookerjee had been avenged. The arrest and detention of Sheikh Abdullah provided the Government of India quite a few years of relative calm.

The summer of 1953 was truly a summer of discontent. Abdullah's dismissal and arrest in August was an intensely debated milestone in India's relations with the state.[33] This milestone was the culmination of a period of double distrust that was symbolised by the defeated US democratic presidential nominee Adlai Stevenson's meetings with Abdullah between 1–3 May 1953. Stevenson and his aides met with Abdullah and his cabinet, where they discussed the creeping influence of communism in Kashmir.[34] Apparently, Abdullah had asked Stevenson for US aid to build Kashmir.[35] After Stevenson left Kashmir for Pakistan,[36] the left-wing Indian press led by *National Herald* and Rusi Karanjia's *Blitz* accused him of having promised US funds to convince Abdullah of the supposed American idea of